THE 5 STAGES OF VELOCITY DEVELOPMENT

Your complete roadmap to throwing harder,
staying healthy, and dominating on the mound.

1	2	3	4	5
INTENT	MECHANICS	BODY	PROGRAMMING	MENTALITY

WATCH THE FULL VIDEO BREAKDOWN

by Trevor Bauer | 4App Sports

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STAGE 1

INTENT

Learn to throw with everything you've got.

HOW YOU KNOW THIS IS YOU

- When you try to throw harder, it feels like there's nothing else there — like you've already hit a wall.
- Your throw doesn't feel powerful, and the ball doesn't come out clean when you add effort.
- Every time you wind up, you're thinking about where the ball is going, your mechanics, or whether you're moving right.
- Your delivery feels slow, stiff, and uncomfortable — there's no rhythm to it.
- When you do try to throw harder, it feels out of control and scary.
- You've never actually practiced throwing as hard as you possibly can without caring where it goes.

WHAT TO WORK ON

- Learn what throwing with maximum effort actually feels like. Just let it rip.
- Throw as hard as you can. Throw as far as you can. Get a radar gun and compete with yourself.
- Stop caring where the ball goes during velocity training — there's a time for accuracy, and this isn't it.
- Get comfortable being uncomfortable. Your mechanics might break down, you might fall over, and that's okay.
- Understand that velocity training and competing in games are two different things — train them separately.
- If you ever feel pain, stop. Discomfort from moving faster than you're used to is fine. Pain is not.

2

STAGE 2

MECHANICS

Move efficiently so your body sends energy into the ball.

HOW YOU KNOW THIS IS YOU

- Your arm hurts or gets sore when you try to throw hard.
- Your command falls apart when you add effort.
- Your velocity stays flat or actually drops when you try to throw harder.
- You're working hard but not seeing results on the radar gun.
- You get tired faster than you should when throwing at full effort.
- Your delivery feels out of sync — one throw feels good but the next feels completely different.
- You put the same effort into each throw but get very different velocities.

WHAT TO WORK ON

- Focus on sequencing, timing, and fluidity. Velocity comes from your body moving in the right order — not your arm doing all the work.
- Use randomized practice: throw from different arm angles, unbalanced positions, jump throws, one-foot throws, on the run, like a catcher, shortstop, or outfielder.
- Always try to hit a specific target every throw, even during randomized practice.
- Check your energy creation: are you drifting too fast, not getting enough depth in your back leg, or delaying hip rotation too long?
- Check your energy transfer: is your front leg stopping your forward momentum quickly enough? Are your hips and shoulders separating properly?
- Check your energy delivery: are you loading your glove side, keeping your elbow below your shoulder line, and staying on-line to the plate?

3

STAGE 3

BODY

Build the engine that creates elite velocity.

HOW YOU KNOW THIS IS YOU

- Your arm doesn't hurt when you throw hard — your mechanics are solid.
- The difference between your high and low velocity in a game is only 3-4 mph.
- You recover quickly and can throw a lot, but your velocity still isn't where you want it.
- You don't feel explosive when you throw — you feel fast but not powerful.
- Your teammates are bigger, stronger, or faster than you.

WHAT TO WORK ON

- Test your strength: if you can't bench 1.5x, squat 2x, and deadlift 2.5x your body weight, strength is your limiting factor. Focus on building volume and getting stronger.
- Test your power: if you're strong but struggle to accelerate weight from a dead stop, shift your focus to moving 70% of your max as fast as possible.
- Test your speed: if you're strong and powerful but don't move faster with light weight or body weight, focus on sprinting and overspeed movements like band-assisted jumps.
- Test your elasticity: do a pause squat jump, a regular vertical jump, and a running jump. If they're close to equal, spend 80% of your training on elasticity.
- Hit your target body weight: 5'6"-5'10" aim for 180-190 lbs, 5'11"-6'2" aim for 200-210 lbs, 6'3"+ aim for 220-230 lbs.
- Eat 1.25g of protein per pound of body weight daily. Include a fruit, vegetable, and clean carb with each meal.
- Supplement omega-3s, vitamin D, protein, and creatine — the most common deficiencies in young pitchers.
- Prioritize sleep: same bedtime every night, same wake time, 16 oz water + 15 min sunlight first thing, 66-degree room, no food within 3 hours of bed.

4

STAGE 4

PROGRAMMING

Optimize every throw to keep your velocity climbing.

HOW YOU KNOW THIS IS YOU

- You're already throwing in the 90s. You're strong, fast, and explosive.
- You move well, you throw with max intent, and your nutrition and recovery are dialed in.
- You've hit a plateau — the gains you made in the weight room have stopped carrying over to your velocity.
- You've been doing the same throwing program for months (or years) and can't remember why you started it.
- You know you can throw harder, but you don't know what to change to get those last couple mph.

WHAT TO WORK ON

- Balance your throwing volumes and intensities. Too much work breaks your body down. Too little means your body never gets the signal to adapt.
- Structure your week with high-intent days, skill development days, and recovery days — and sync those with your strength and conditioning program.
- Add structured progressions to your throwing program. Just like you add weight in the gym, change your throwing stimulus when progress flatlines.
- Track your data obsessively. A 2% change in your long toss distance equals about 2 mph. If you can't notice small changes, you can't fix them.
- Monitor everything: velocity, arm soreness, general fatigue, and how your body responds to different workouts and sessions.
- Adjust your program based on your bullpen and game schedule, your primary constraint, and when you need peak performance.

5

STAGE 5

MENTALITY

Use your velocity to dominate in games.

HOW YOU KNOW THIS IS YOU

There are three types of Stage 5 pitchers:

- Command Guy: Your in-game velocity matches your bullpen, but you're walking and hitting batters. You might have an eyesight problem (not locking onto a target), a focus problem (thinking too much on the mound), or a feel problem (your fingers and brain aren't communicating well).
- Confidence Guy: You hold back in games because you don't trust your stuff. You get nervous in big moments, tighten up with runners on base, or don't believe your command will be there at full effort.
- Stuff Guy: Your velocity is there and walks aren't the issue, but you're giving up hits and runs. Either your individual pitches aren't good enough, your pitches don't work well together, or you're throwing the wrong pitches at the wrong time.

WHAT TO WORK ON

- Command fix — eyesight: Pick a tiny target on every throw (belt buckle, hat logo, tape on a net). Try throwing with one eye closed or goggles with pinhole lenses to force your brain to lock in.
- Command fix — focus: Practice switching between analytical mode (throw, get feedback, adjust) and game mode (see target, throw, repeat with zero thought). Train turning your brain off between pitches.
- Command fix — feel: Throw objects with different shapes, sizes, and textures (lemons, softballs, golf balls, 4-oz and 6-oz balls) at a target. High volume, low intent. Your fingertip-to-brain connection will sharpen.
- Confidence fix: Make training harder than any game you'll ever face. Add real consequences — embarrassment, money, competition. Simulate worst-case scenarios (bases loaded, one pitch only) so games feel easy by comparison.
- Stuff fix — pitch design: Improve velocity, spin rate, spin axis, or seam orientation. Think of your arsenal as a system: do your pitches create movement in multiple directions and at different speeds?
- Stuff fix — hitter reading: Learn to read swing plane (flat vs. steep), timing (early vs. late), and body language. Watch games and predict what you'd throw before each pitch to build your baseball IQ.

READY TO START
THROWING HARDER?

Now you know the 5 stages — but knowing where you are is only half the battle. You need a plan built for YOU.

We Can Help

- Diagnose exactly which stage you're in right now.
- Identify the specific thing holding you back from throwing harder.
- Build a custom plan built for your body, your arm, and your goals.
- No guessing. No generic programs. Just a clear path forward.

BOOK A CALL

"The goal isn't just velocity. It's dominating every hitter you face."

— Trevor Bauer